

Fajardo, Mike Ivan L.

BSIT – 4B

Quiz #1 (100 points): Present your answer in a matrix form on ethical theories as to its definition and present scenario/example where you can explain the specific ethical theory (example shall be correlated to “Information Technology”)

Note: submit in our designated google drive till 12PM of August 11, 2026 (Convert to PDF before submitting)

Ethical Theory	Definition	Example
Utilitarianism	An action is considered morally right if it produces the greatest benefit and well-being for the largest number of people, while minimizing overall harm.	A software development group determines to build an important security patch temporarily bringing down a system for a number of users. While a brief inconvenience to a lot of people, millions of users will be kept safe from a serious data breach, and hopefully for the better of the community in the long run.
Deontology (Duty Based Ethics)	An action is inherently right or wrong based on duty, moral rules, and principles, regardless of the consequences or outcomes.	A high-level executive gives a direct order to a system administrator to give a competitor their own private user information. The administrator resists doing it because it is the wrong thing to do and no matter what the consequences may be or the pressure that may be put on him, it is unethical.
Virtue Ethics	Focuses on cultivating sound moral character traits—such as honesty, integrity, fairness, and accountability—rather than merely following rules or evaluating consequences.	The lead developer finds an unknown problem in a banking app that could allow customers to have their information reveal. Being honest, accountable and reliable is a part of their character so they report and fix the bug immediately, no one knows of it yet, just the right thing to do.
Rights Theory	Asserts that every individual possesses fundamental moral rights—such as privacy, autonomy, and security—that must be respected and protected by others.	A public facing end-to-end encrypted messaging app for a company that builds IT solutions. They intentionally create the system so as not to be able to read private conversations between users, and thus it protects the fundamental rights of the users with regard to their personal privacy and personal communications.

Justice and Fairness Theory	Requires that benefits, responsibilities, and burdens be distributed equitably, ensuring all individuals are treated fairly without bias or discrimination.	The company is an AI firm that is developing a facial recognition system. They are very aware of the importance of equal treatment and are committed to investing more resources in collecting as many data sets as possible to ensure their software is equally effective for men and women, and people with different skin tones, without causing algorithmic bias and unfair treatment.
Ethical Relativism	View that believes morals are not universal and that moral norms and values are entirely determined by cultural, legal, or societal norms of a particular group.	While pirating software or digital files might be considered illegal and unethical in one country, it can be legal and acceptable in another area where digital sharing is considered a normal community norm and standard practice.
Social Contract Theory	This states that individuals consent to follow a set of rules, standards, and laws so that the group/society they create can provide for their safety, security, order, and protection.	Users accept liability for complying with a website's Terms of Service (ToS) which include agreeing not to upload malware or attack the system. The platform, in return, offers a secure, stable, and protected online environment where everyone can safely interact and conduct business.

REFERENCES:

- **Deontology & Duty Ethics:** Alexander, L., & Moore, M. (2020). *Deontological ethics*. Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy. <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/ethics-deontological/>
- **Utilitarianism:** Ethics Unwrapped. (2022). *Utilitarianism*. McCombs School of Business, The University of Texas at Austin. <https://ethicsunwrapped.utexas.edu/glossary/utilitarianism>
- **Virtue Ethics:** Hursthouse, R., & Pettigrove, G. (2022). *Virtue ethics*. Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy. <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/ethics-virtue/>
- **Social Contract Theory:** Ethics Unwrapped. (2022). *Social contract theory*. McCombs School of Business, The University of Texas at Austin. <https://ethicsunwrapped.utexas.edu/glossary/social-contract-theory>
- **Justice & Fairness:** Ethics Unwrapped. (2022). *Justice theory*. McCombs School of Business, The University of Texas at Austin. <https://ethicsunwrapped.utexas.edu/glossary/justice-theory>

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